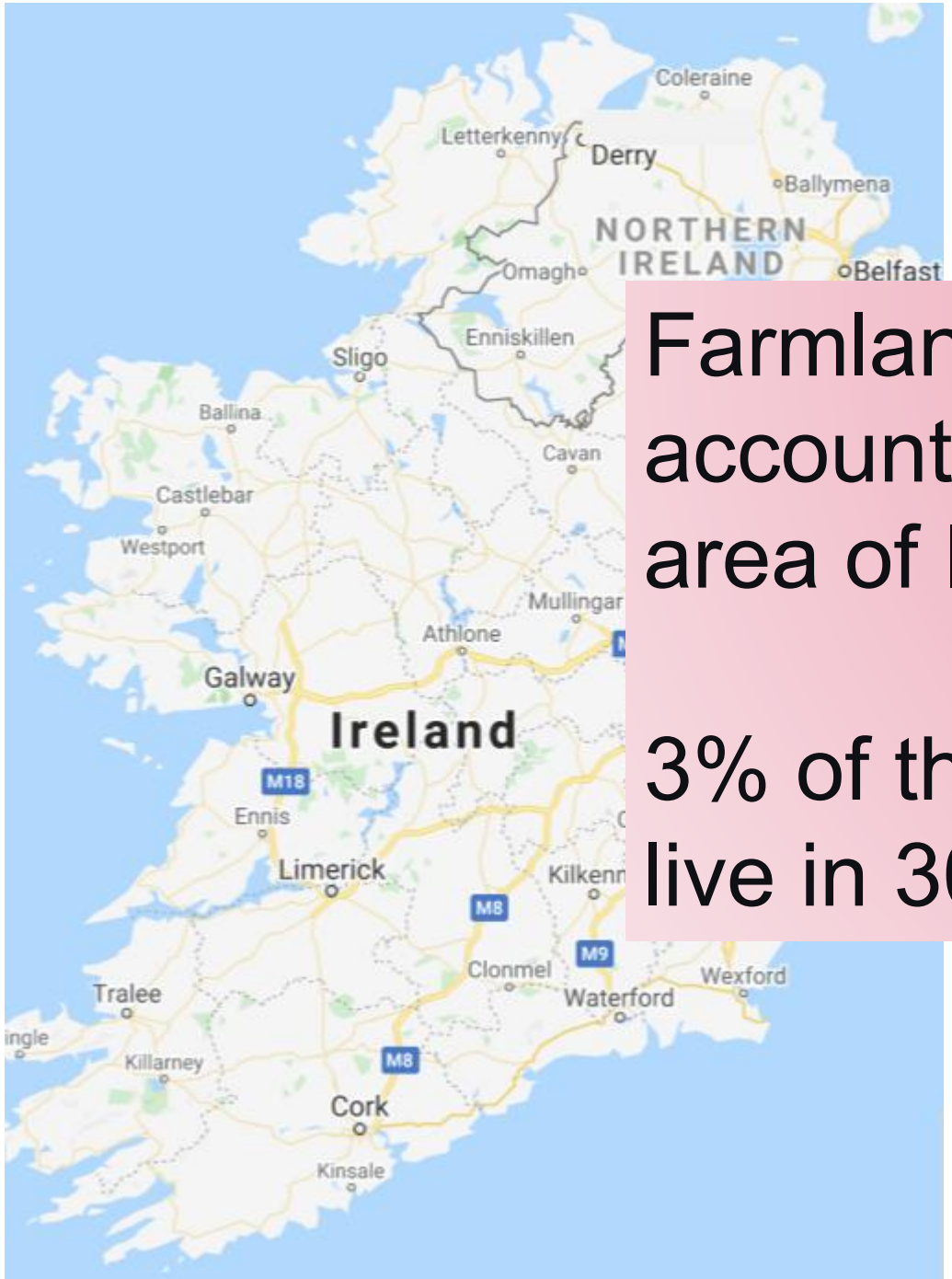
BEREC
Body of European Regulators for Electronic Communications

BEREC's work on the 2G/3G switch-off

Regulatel working group meeting, Montevideo
13 - 14 Oct 2026

Joe Lynch (ComReg),
Sietse van der Gaast (ACM)

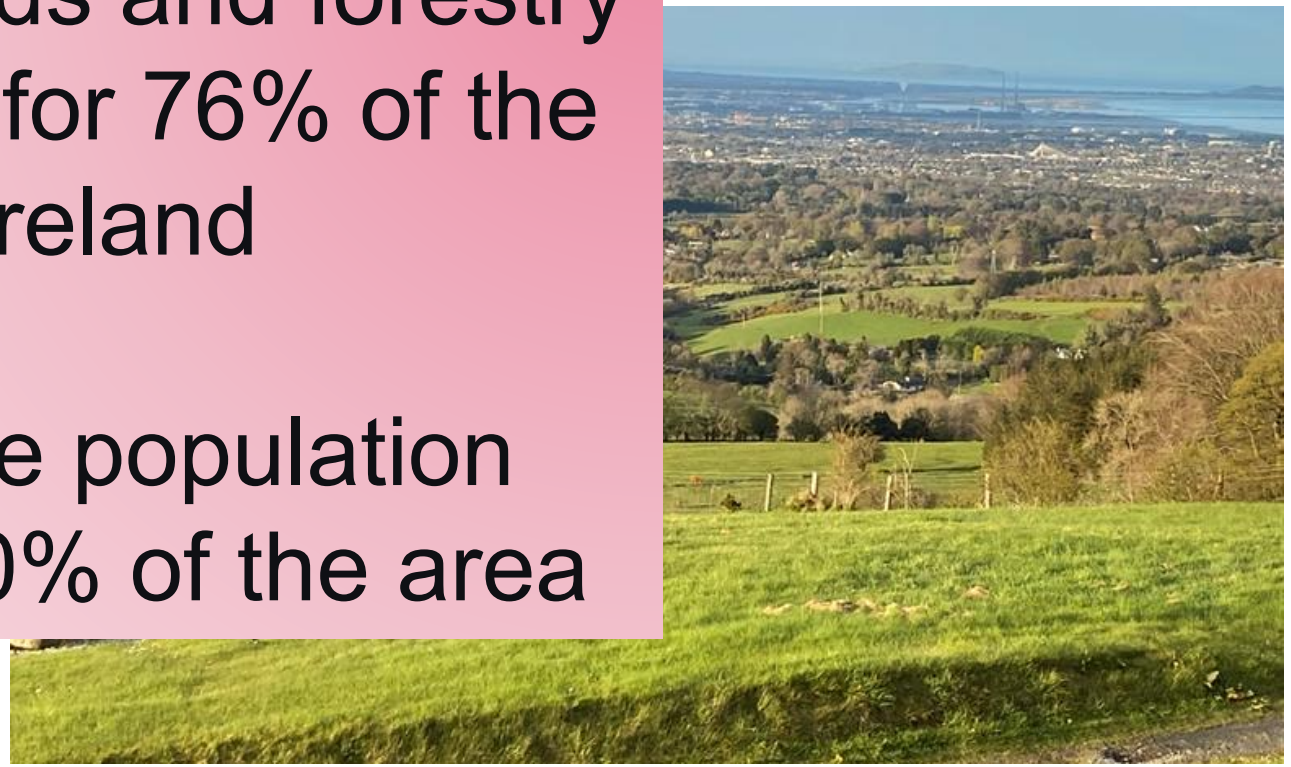
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Éire

Farmlands and forestry account for 76% of the area of Ireland

3% of the population live in 30% of the area



Opening remarks (1)

- Some short opening remarks to introduce BEREC's WNE WG





Commission for Communications Regulation

Autoriteit Consument & Markt

Opening remarks (2)

BEREC Mini-board ‘26

- **Akos**
- CNMC
- Agcom
- Arcep
- ComReg
- BIPT
- RTR
- Ekip





Vice-Chair / Board Members who sponsor WNE WG
Dr. Milan B. Radulovic, Ekip
Dr. Klaus M. Steinmauer, RTR

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Opening remarks (3)

- Working methods
  1. Weekly meetings
  2. Predominantly online
  3. Key meetings in-person!
  4. NRA survey, desk research and analysis
  5. Thank you to organisers/host

     and to

     Antonio Serra

     Rita Silva



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1

Legacy wireless technology phasetouts “2G & 3G Switch-off”

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End Users care about services not underlying technologies

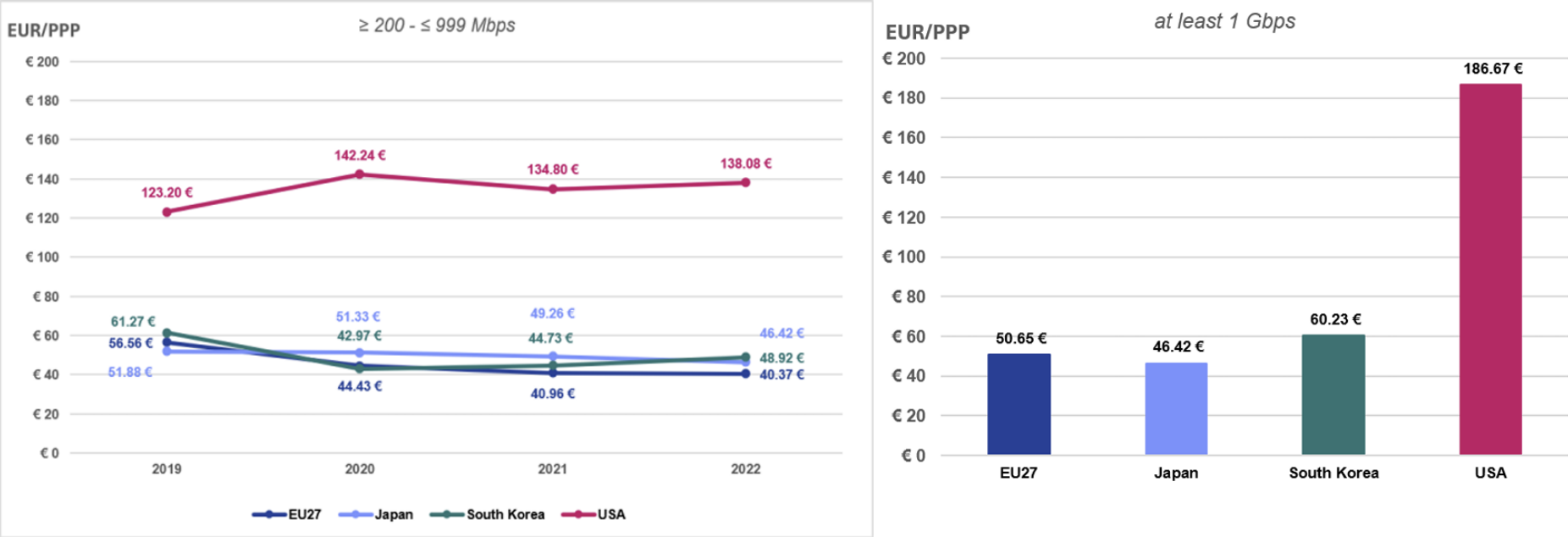


Price, Quality, Choice for consumers

EU telecoms sector shows *"[]…affordable prices…"*

BoR(26) 137

Figure 8 – Lowest offers for 3-play (FI, FT and TV) with fixed broadband speeds of [200Mbps, 1Gbps) and >1Gbps respectively, by jurisdiction



Source: Mobile and Fixed Broadband Prices in Europe reports, 2019-2022.

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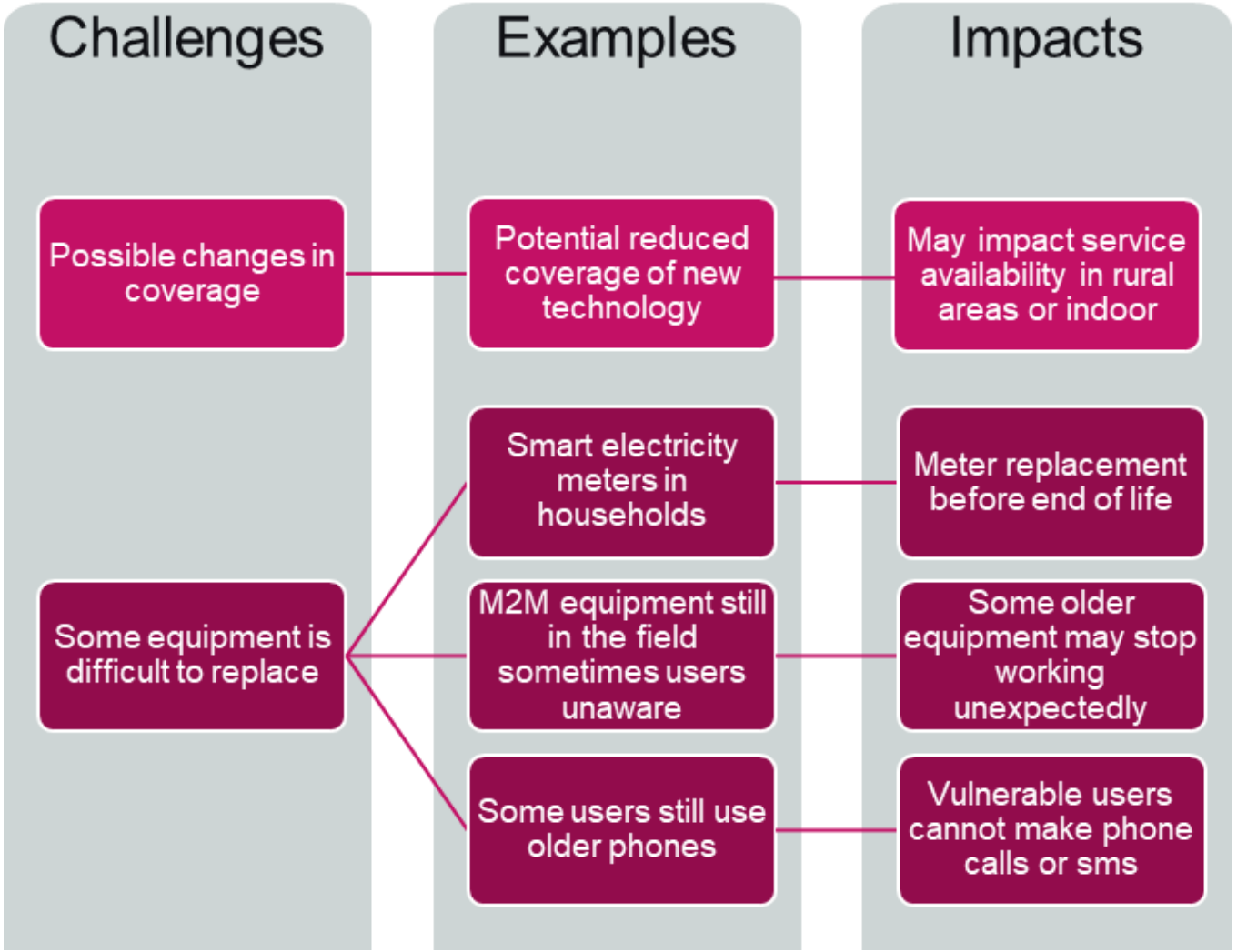
Context

- In the majority of European countries, radio spectrum for mobile services is assigned on a service- & technology-neutral basis
- It is up to the industry, and in particular the MNOs, to decide if, when and how to introduce and/or phaseout technologies
- Circuit switched mobile technology will function as a fallback until a network phases out of **both 2G and 3G.** After that only packet switched technology is available

Phaseouts: achieving great goals comes not without challenges (1)

More efficient spectrum use: stop inefficient technology (also phaseout older radio layer technology)

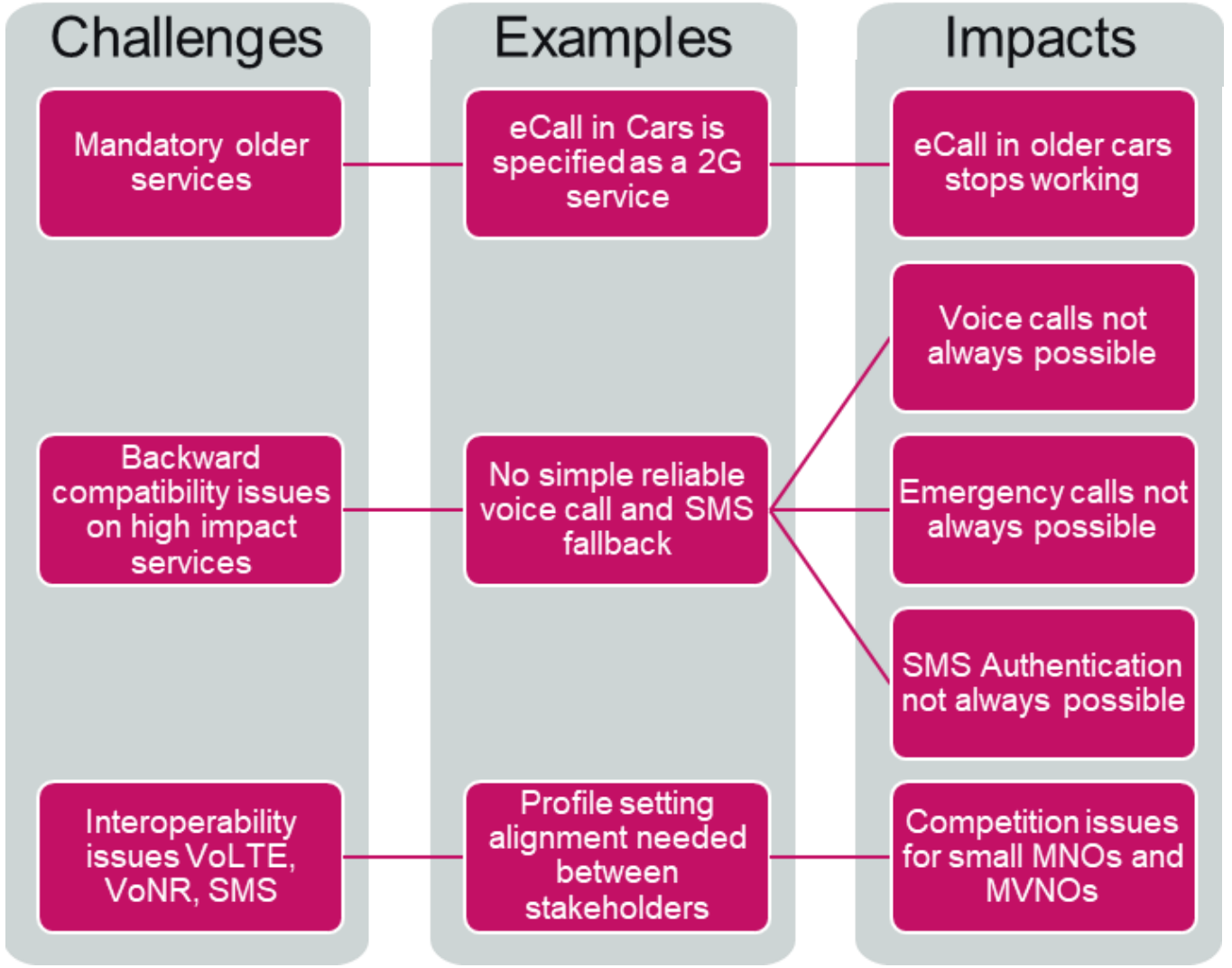
Better efficiency, reliability, security and sustainability: decommission older equipment



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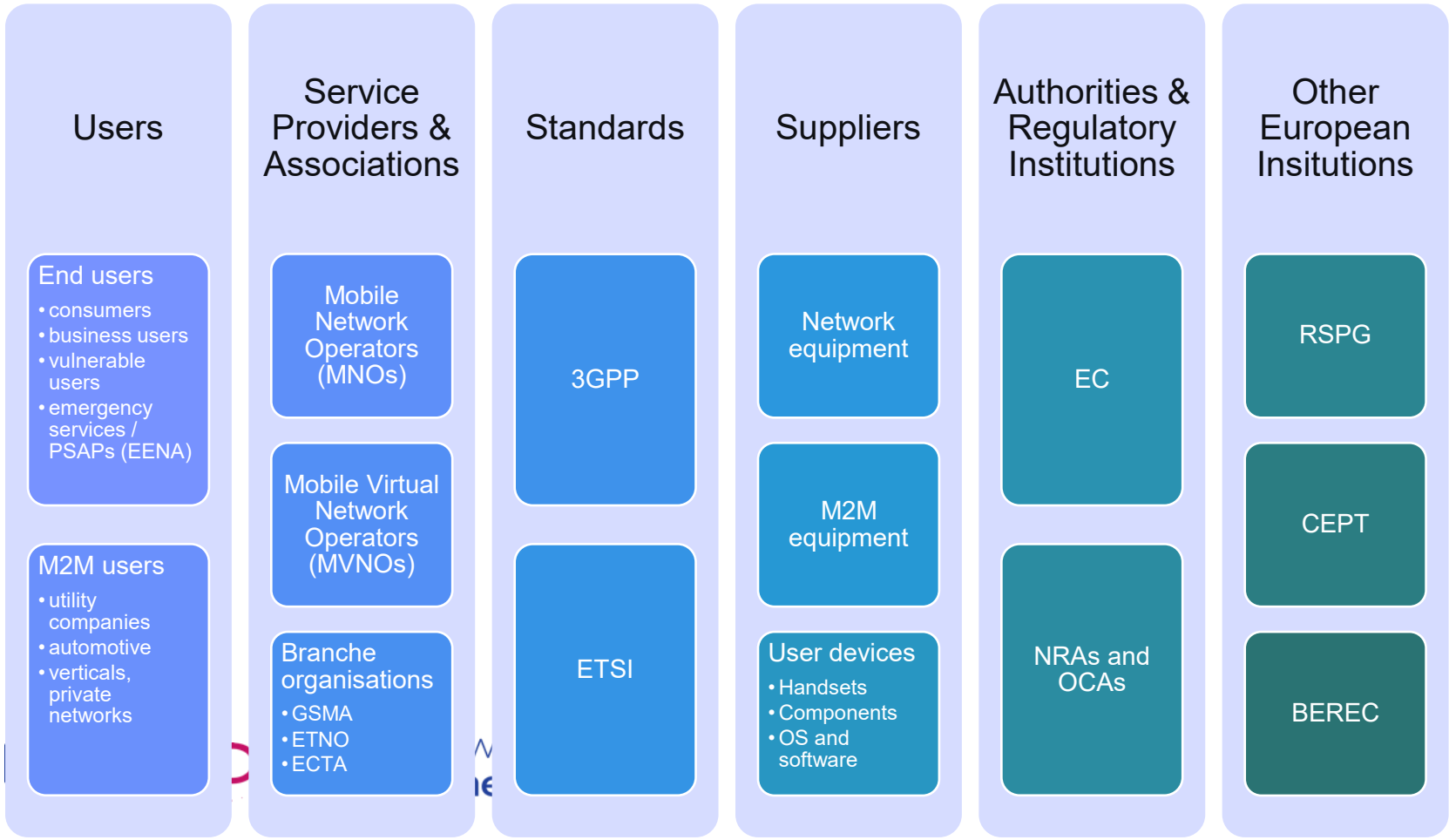
Phaseouts: achieving great goals comes not without challenges (2)

Focus on new services:
better quality, choice, flexibility



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Phaseouts: Multi-facet and Multi-stakeholder



Practices

- Good engagement between stakeholders
- Workshops
- Use of notice periods so stakeholders can make relevant preparations
- Support to affected users
- Observations and recommendations in RSPG report
- Dissemination of information and guidelines to the public
- Cooperation between NRAs and OCAs

112 issue

- BEREC published a report on possible issues in 2023 and has been following practices and challenges with the phaseout of 2G and 3G for several years
- The combination of 2G and 3G phaseout is challenging in general, but the issue with access to 112 and other emergency numbers is important and urgent
  - For some combinations of 4G/5G devices and some mobile networks, access to emergency numbers fails once both 2G and 3G are not available anymore, while other services such as internet access and regular phone calls are still possible
  - The fallback (Limited Service State aka Emergency Roaming) is not sufficient
- Since December issues with emergency access were shared in BEREC
  - BEREC exchanged descriptions of the problem, concerns, observations, possible solutions
  - Co-chairs engaged with various stakeholders inside and outside BEREC
- EENA also raised attention to this issue (EENA calls for delay of the 2G/3G shutdown until emergency communications issues are resolved – EENA)
  - And organized activities to discuss details, such as:
    End to end testing for emergency communications in 4G and 5G, 16 June

BEREC Statement, 2 June

- People expect 112 to work. BEREC expects 112 to work. The EECC framework requires it
  - Our observations are degradation of 112 access may occur, and its root cause is multifaceted, with unknown scale
  - Degradation of 112 access is unacceptable
- The problem of degradation of 112 access reliability can only be solved by a combination of stakeholders in the market
- This short BEREC statement urges all stakeholders to play their role in problem detection and problem mitigation
  - Stakeholders involved in phaseouts should perform risk assessments
- Transparency is needed to increase awareness of all stakeholders of problems and solutions

Iceland, 15 June

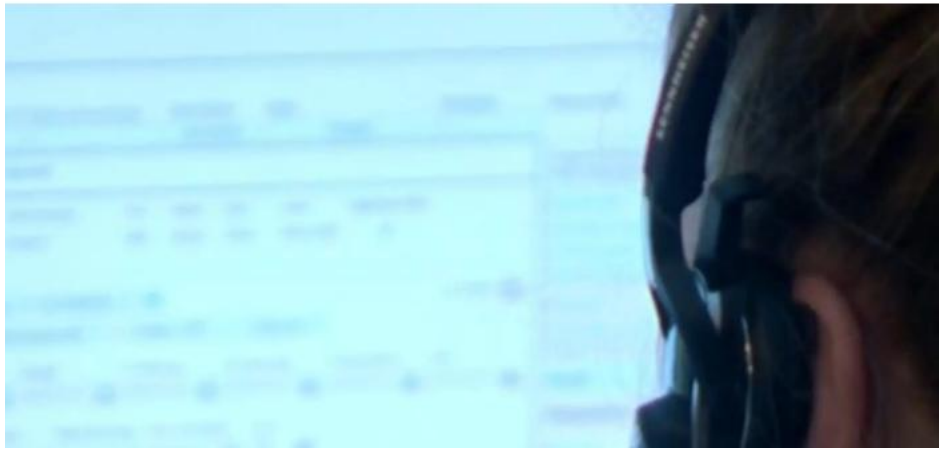
News from Iceland

Unclear why family was unable to reach emergency services

People are encouraged to call 1280 to ensure they can reach emergency services through their phone. A family from Skagaströnd was unable to get through despite multiple calls.

Ólöf Rún Erlendsdóttir og Hugrún Hannesdóttir Diego
15. June 2026 - 16:02 GMT

A A A



It remains unclear why a man from Skagaströnd was unable to reach Emergency Services (Neyðarlínan) on Friday despite repeated calls. Emergency Services, the Icelandic Telecommunications Authority (Fjarskiptastofa) and telecommunications companies are investigating the matter.

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Iceland, 15 June

- ECoI says the situation is also constantly changing; the telephone companies have been responding and increasing the number of transmitters. The coverage of 4G transmitters is about 1% to 7% less in rural areas than in 3G. It is their responsibility to ensure that customers do not receive poorer service than before the change.
- *"The companies should have taken measures to compensate for the fact that at the edge of the transmitters' coverage area, service may have been disrupted. This was known in advance."*

Some immediate considerations

- Operator risk assessment is key
- Regulator blocking phones is not a step to be taken lightly
  - How to identify & detect problematic phones
  - How to remove them from the market
- BEREC keen to avoid fragmented approach in Europe, but we start to see this is a possibility given the different stages of phaseout in countries
- End-to-end network testing is also import
  - One sim in one model of phone may work but not in a different model in a different network, which makes this complex

Summary and future work

- The problems are not gone when phaseout of both 2G and 3G are complete
- Ideally, 4G(+) devices that can not properly function without 2G or 3G should be upgraded or otherwise pushed off the European market.
  - But how?
- In most cases roaming with 2G or 3G devices possible until the last MNO in a country phases out 2G and 3G
  - After that also 2G eCall will stop working in a country
  - Recent report commissioned by EC advises the EC to propose to MS to keep at least one 2G network alive until 2030
- BEREC wants to add to relevant discussions in the draft Digital Networks Act
  - BEREC calls for more attention for technology migrations
- BEREC to work on Phaseout issues in 2027

Bibliography of BEREC publications on 2G/3G phaseout

- 2023 Final report: BEREC report on 2G/3G phaseout practices and challenges
  - https://www.berec.europa.eu/en/document-categories/berec/reports/berec-report-on-2g3g-phaseout-practics-and-challenges

- 2023 Summary report summarizing the consultation responses:
  - https://www.berec.europa.eu/en/document-categories/berec/reports/summary-report-on-the-outcome-of-the-public-consultation-on-the-draft-report-on-practices-and-challenges-of-the-phasing-out-of-2g-and-3g

- 2023 Draft report and consultation announcement:
  - Public consultation on the Draft BEREC Report on practices and challenges of the phasing out of 2G and 3G | BEREC

- 2024/5 Internal and workshop(s) – Agendas available on request

- **2026 BEREC Statement urges operators, device manufacturers, and all other stakeholders to ensure emergency calls access in the context of 2G and 3G phaseout**
  - **https://www.berec.europa.eu/en/all-documents/berec/opinions/berec-statement-berec-urges-operators-device-manufacturers-and-all-other-stakeholders-to-ensure-emergency-calls-access-in-the-context-of-2g3g-phaseout**

BEREC



Thank you for your attention

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EUconnectivity

Joe.Lynch@comreg.ie

Happy to discuss